

ISC-FICCI Award

TOWARDS NIRMAL GUJARAT 2.0: THE ROAD AHEAD

- The focus remains on:
- Enhancing plastic waste management systems.
- Promoting eco-friendly practices.
- Ensuring dignity for sanitation workers.
- Developing revenue models to sustain SBM-G.

on toilet construction, waste collection, and liquid waste management. This data-driven approach ensures accountability, transparency, and continuous improvement.

Collaborations with Self-Help Groups (SHGs), local industries, and the Roads and Buildings (R&B) Department have addressed specific challenges, such as plastic waste management. By converging efforts across sectors like health, education, and rural development, Gujarat has created a holistic approach to sanitation.

CHANGING MINDSETS: SOCIAL BEHAVIORAL CHANGE AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Leadership and community engagement have been instrumental in Gujarat's sanitation journey. Under the able leadership of Chief Minister Shri Bhupendra Patel, the Swachhta Hi Sewa (SHS) 2023 campaign inspired millions. The 'Ek Tareekh Ek Ghanta Ek Saath' initiative, called by Hon'blePrime Minister Narendra Modi, saw around 2 crore people from Gujarat participate in cleanliness drives. Students, politicians, government officials, NGOs, and industries joined hands, proving that Swachh Bharat is a people's movement, not just a government program.

In 2024, the Swachhta Hi Sewa campaign, led by Shri Raghavjibhai Patel, Hon'ble Cabinet Minister, and Shri KunvarjibhaiHalpati, Hon'ble Minister of State for Rural Development, transformed 19,312 Cleanliness Target Units (CTUs) with over 2.25 crore participants. Initiatives like "Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam" resulted in the plantation of 2,647 trees, promoting sustainability. Sanitation workers contributed



Swachhta Pledge

RECOGNIZING EXCELLENCE: GUJARAT'S NATIONAL ACCOLADES

Gujarat's commitment to SBM has earned it the "Special Recognition to Governments" Award at the 8th ISC-FICCI Sanitation Awards 2024. Initiatives like the Gobardhan Project and Grey Water Management under the Vedanchha Model have set benchmarks in sustainable sanitation practices.

67,493 hours of Shramdaan, and 10,000 Swachhta Shivirs provided health checkups and support for their invaluable work.

These campaigns have helped change mindsets, making cleanliness a social norm. Villagers are now proud of their clean surroundings and are actively involved in maintaining them. Children, in particular, have become ambassadors of cleanliness, spreading the message in their families and communities.

WOMEN LEADING THE CHANGE

Women have been the backbone of Gujarat's sanitation revolution. The installation of biogas plants has alleviated the burden on women, who previously spent hours collecting firewood. A Sabar Dairy survey found that 93% of households reported improved health after installing biogas plants, with significant reductions in respiratory ailments. Women now save an average of 1.85 hours daily, which they can use for income-generating activities or personal development.

In Harsol village, women from the Sakhi Mandal Self-Help Group lead waste management efforts. Ten women, including Ms. Ramilaben Pravinbhai Chamar, trained to drive an e-rickshaw, collect waste door-to-door. Earning ₹273 daily, they promote both cleanliness and economic empowerment. Their vehicles—equipped for wet and dry waste segregation—ensure efficient recycling.

Rajiben Vankar of Avadhnagar village in Bhuj has pioneered plastic waste upcycling. Using traditional weaving techniques, she and her team have recycled over 10 lakh plastic bags into products like bags and pouches, earning ₹7,000-8,000 monthly. Recognized by President Smt. Droupadi Murmu, Rajiben's initiative highlights how grassroots leadership can drive sustainability.

THE IMPACT OF CHANGE

Gujarat's relentless efforts have garnered national acclaim. The Gujarat Commissionerate of Rural Development (CRD) received the "Special Recognition to Governments" Award at the 8th ISC-FICCI Sanitation Awards on November 26, 2024. Innovations like the Gobardhan Project and Greywater Management under the Vedanchha Model have set benchmarks for the nation.

The journey doesn't end with achieving ODF status. Gujarat is committed to sustaining and expanding these efforts. Enhancing solid and plastic waste management, promoting eco-friendly practices, and developing model villages remain priorities. Recognizing sanitation workers' contributions, the state ensures they receive respect, dignity, and social recognition.

As Gujarat sets an example for the nation, it reminds us all: "True progress lies not only in what we build, but in how we sustain it– for cleanliness is the foundation of dignity, health, and a brighter, sustainable future for all."